Stellar Cyber 6.6.0s is now live! Discover all the updates in the release notes!

Using the XDR Kill Chain (Home Page)

Learn more at Stellar Cyber Academy.

The following links take you to courses on the Stellar Cyber Academy technical training portal where you can learn more about a topic by watching the suggested lessons.

J02 Introduction to Features in the User Interface (02h:24m)

Alerts in the UI (07m:00s)

Explore the Alerts view, learning how to filter, sort, and manage Alerts within the Stellar Cyber Platform. Understand how machine learning drives alert generation and prioritization, and how to use these alerts to create custom Cases.

Alert Management (33m:00s)

Explore available views for managing and investigating alerts, including the Alerts Table, Kill Chain, and Threat Hunting views within the Stellar Cyber Platform. Learn to leverage MITRE ATT&CK data, threat intelligence, and toolbar filters to enhance alert triage and investigation workflows. Follow along with a demonstration on interacting with alerts across different views, applying search tool queries, and conducting threat-hunting activities efficiently. Discover how to tune alert settings and use custom filtering options for focused analysis across the data lake.

J03 Investigations and Workflows (05h:48m)

Built-In Investigation Views (25m:00s)

Get familiar with built-in investigation views within the Stellar Cyber Platform, such as case views, alerts, and kill chain views. Learn how to prioritize and sort cases and alerts for effective triage, using these views to drive incident response.

The first time you access a link on the portal during a session, you must log in to access content.

The XDR Kill Chain dashboard is the default home page for Stellar Cyber. It provides a central location for assessing overall risk and threats found within the environment. Drilldowns to

ongoing cases, risky assets, and tactics help you keep the environment and its systems secure by zeroing in on what requires immediate attention.

The illustration below introduces you to the XDR Kill Chain dashboard's major components. Following the illustration, you can review detailed information on each of the main components.

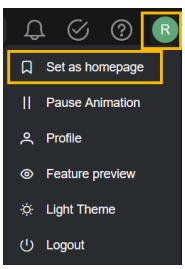


- XDR Kill Chain Loop – Provides critical/total alert counts at each of the XDR Kill Chain stages; select a stage to drill to the Alert Types page for the corresponding stage. Critical alerts are those with an Alert Score of 75 or greater.
- Status Panel – Provides at-a-glance status graphs for case status, cases, alerts, users, and assets, including trend information.
- Top Cases Panel – Lists collapsible capsule summaries of the top cases by score; select a case to drill to its Case Detail view.
- Top Risky Assets Panel – Lists collapsible capsule summaries of the top risky assets by score with multiple drilldowns for further analysis.
- Tactics Panel – Provides a bar graph quantifying the alerts observed by Stellar Cyber according to their corresponding tactics. You can filter by critical or non-critical tactics and drill to a view of the Alert Types page filtered by the corresponding tactic.
- Common Controls – Provides the standard menu bar, as well as search, query, and filter controls that appear throughout Stellar Cyber.

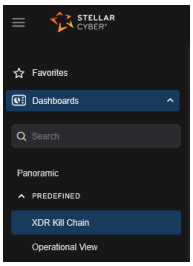
Getting Back to the XDR Kill Chain Dashboard

The Stellar Cyber XDR Kill Chain dashboard appears immediately after you log in and is the system's default home page:

- If you have not changed your home page by selecting the **Set as homepage** menu item from the upper, right-most icon, you can get back to the XDR Kill Chain dashboard by selecting the Stellar Cyber logo at the upper left of the display or by selecting the **Dashboards | PREDEFINED | XDR Kill Chain** menu item.



- If you have changed your home page by selecting the **Set as homepage** menu item, you can get back to the XDR Kill Chain dashboard by selecting the **Dashboards | PREDEFINED | XDR Kill Chain** menu item.

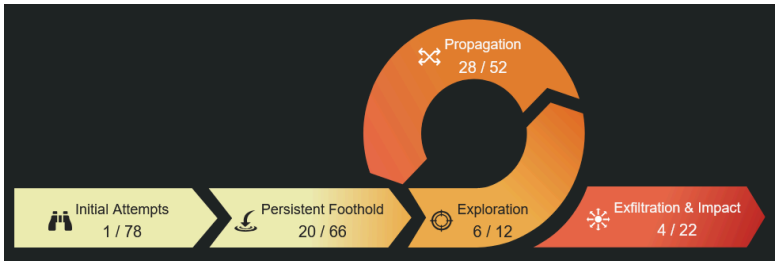


- You can assign a different page to display when you select the Stellar Cyber logo (**Home**). When you navigate away from the **XDR Kill Chain** page (which is the default for **Home**), for example, to the Alerts page, you can select the **Set as homepage** menu item to make that page your new Home page. You can toggle it back by select the **Unset as homepage** menu item.

XDR Kill Chain

The centerpiece of the XDR Kill Chain dashboard is the XDR Kill Chain loop. The XDR Kill Chain identifies five separate stages on the attack landscape, each with its own associated tactics and techniques. Tactics and techniques include both those based on the MITRE | ATT&CK framework, as well as native XDR versions developed by Stellar Cyber. You can hover your mouse over any XDR Kill Chain stage to see a popup listing the tactics tracked at the corresponding stage.

Each of the stages reports counts for critical and total alerts within the selected filters and provides a drilldown to the Alert Types display, filtered for the corresponding stage.



The XDR Kill Chain includes the following stages, each identified by its own distinctive color and icon. These colors and icons are used consistently throughout the user interface to reinforce stage identification.

XDR Kill Chain Stage	Icon	Summary	Associated MITRE | ATT&CK Tactics	Associated XDR Tactics	Classic Attacks
Initial Attempts		Attackers are trying to access your network.	Resource Development External Credential Access Reconnaissance Initial Access	XDR SBA External XDR NBA External XDR UBA	• Port scanning • External brute force login attempts • Phishing • Probes of known security holes

Persistent Foothold		Attackers are trying to maintain access to your systems in spite of [illegible]nsive techniques.	Persistence Execution Defense Evasion Command and Control	XDR EBA External XDR Malware XDR Intel	• External trojans • Account manipulation
Exploration		Attackers are inspecting your network, learning about your environment before taking further action.	Collection Discovery	Internal XDR NBA	• Internal port scans • External SQL dumpfiles • Suspicious SMB copies
Propagation		Attackers are trying to obtain additional privileges and access and control additional systems on your network.	Internal Credential Access Privilege Escalation Lateral Movement	Internal XDR UBA Internal XDR Malware	• Internal spyware • Internal trojans • Internal brute force
Exfiltration & Impact		Attackers are trying to steal data, potentially dumping it in a way that avoids detection, and/or vandalizing your systems and data.	Exfiltration Impact		• Syn floods • Ransomware • File action anomalies

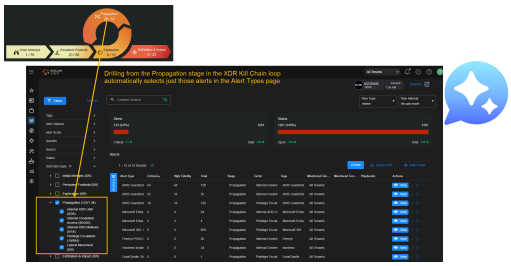
This Kill Chain loop provides an immediate barometer of the quantity and severity of the events observed by Stellar Cyber within the current filter settings. Each stage of the Kill Chain loop is shown with counts for critical and total alerts within the current filters:

- The number on the left reports the number of critical alerts within the current filters. These alerts have been scored by machine learning services with a Alert Score of 75 or greater and are most likely to need immediate attention.
- The number on the right reports the total number of alerts detected within the current filters.

The dashboard only shows data matching the current filters set using the controls at the top of the display (time, event score, sensor, and so on).

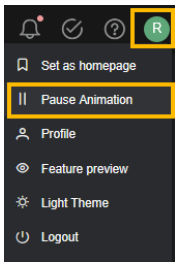
Drilling to Alerts from the XDR Kill Chain Loop

You can select any of the stages in the XDR Kill Chain loop to drill to the Alerts page with a display filter automatically applied so that just the alert types at the selected stage are displayed, as illustrated in the figure below.



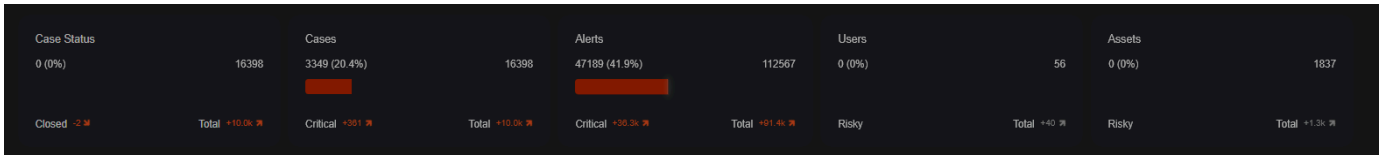
Pausing the XDR Kill Chain Loop

You can pause the animation of the XDR Kill Chain loop from upper, right-most menu, as shown below:

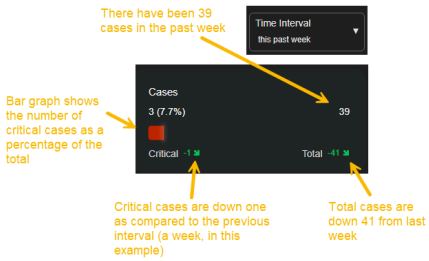


Status Panel

The Status panel appears immediately above the **XDR Kill Chain** and displays separate, color-coded cards illustrating counts and trends for **Case Status**, **Cases**, **Alerts**, **Users**, and **Assets**.



The bar graphs and counters in the Status Panel cards all function in roughly the same way. Consider the **Cases** status card shown below:



- **Case Status** – Use this panel to gauge your progress on addressing cases that match the selected filters:
    - The bar graph shows the number of **Closed** cases (those with a **Status** of either **Resolved** or **Cancelled** set in the Case Detail page) compared to the total number of cases that match the selected filters.
    - The **Closed** indicator shows you the trend in case closure, comparing the net increase or drop in closed cases to the previous time window of the same size. Closed cases are those with a status of either **Resolved** or **Cancelled** in the Case Detail page.
    - The **Total** indicator shows you the trend in total cases, comparing the net increase or drop in total case closures to the previous time interval of the same

size.

- **Cases** – Use this panel to assess the number of cases that match the selected filters. The bar graph, **Critical** and **Total** indicators all function in roughly the same ways as the Cases Status panel, except for critical and total case creation.
- **Alerts** – Use this panel to assess the number of critical alerts detected in the selected time interval. The bar graph, **Critical** and **Total** indicators all function in roughly the same ways as the Case Status panel, except for critical and total alert creation.
- **Users** – Use this panel to assess the number of risky users detected in the selected time interval. The bar graph, **Risky** and **Total** indicators all function in roughly the same ways as the Case Status panel, except for total and risky user detection.
- **Assets** – Use this panel to assess the number of risky assets detected in the selected time interval. The bar graph, **Risky** and **Total** indicators all function in roughly the same ways as the Case Status panel, except for risky and total asset detection.

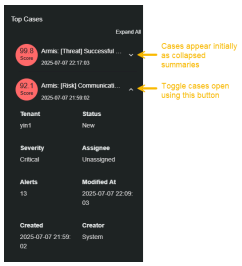
Top Cases Panel

The Top Cases panel lists the most severe Cases for the selected tenant in the selected **Time Interval** according to their score. The panel is located at the left of the XDR Kill Chain dashboard, directly under the **Case Status** and **Cases** panels, handily arranging these related tools together.

The Top Cases panel only displays **open** cases, regardless of the setting of the **Status** filter at the left of the display. Because of this, any cases you have set to **Resolved** or **Cancelled** do not appear in the Top Cases panel.

A case is a set of multiple correlated alerts and entities constituting a potential unified security attack, ranked by a dynamically updated score indicating the severity of the attack. Stellar Cyber uses its machine-learning capabilities to generate cases automatically, grouping related alerts into a unified case for improved attack resolution.

Cases appear initially in the Top Cases panel as collapsed summary entries, but can be cascaded open using the **v** button at their right, as shown below. You can also expand all of the entries in the list using the **Expand all** button at the top of the panel.



Cases are reported in the Top Cases panel with the following information:

- **Name** – Stellar Cyber automatically assigns a name to each Case it reports. You can either accept the default name or supply your own in the Case Detail view.
- **Tenant** – The tenant with which this Case is associated.
- **Ticket ID** – The system-assigned ticket number for the Case.

- **Status** – The status associated with this Case. Can be either **New**, **Escalated**, **In Progress**, **Resolved**, or **Cancelled**. You can change the status in the Case Detail view, giving you a handy way to track your team's Case response over time.
- **Case Score** – The severity of the Case, as determined by Stellar Cyber. The score updates in real time as events and entities are added to or removed from the Case. Scores are color-coded to indicate their severity.
- **Alerts** – A count of the alerts associated with the Case.

  The maximum of associated alerts is 5,000.
- **Severity**– The priority of the Case. Cases start out with a **Medium** priority, but can be changed in the Case Detail view to **Low**, **High**, or **Critical**.
- **Assignee** – The assignee for the Case, if any. You can assign resources to Cases in the Case Detail view.
- **Modified At** – The last time the Case was modified by a user, either by changing any of its properties (for example, changing its status or name), or by adding/removing any event associated with the Case.
- **Creator** – The user account that created the Case. Cases created by Stellar Cyber are listed with a creator of **System**.
- **Created** – The time at which the Case was created by Stellar Cyber.

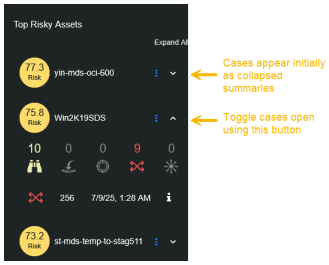
Drilling to the Case Detail Page

To view the Case Detail view for the corresponding Case, select the Case name in the Top Cases panel.

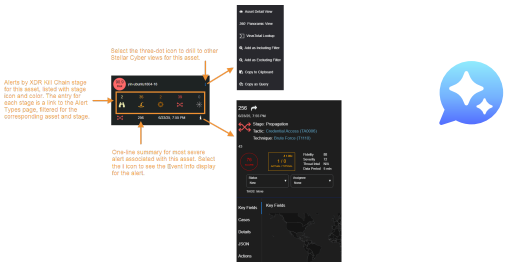
Top Risky Assets Panel

The Top Risky Assets panel lists assets in the selected Time Interval in descending order of Risk Score. The panel is located at the right of the XDR Kill Chain dashboard, directly under the **Assets** status panel, handily arranging these related tools together.

Assets appear initially in the Top Assets panel as collapsed summary entries, but can be cascaded open using the **v** button at their right, as shown below. You can also expand all of the entries in the list using the **Expand all** button at the top of the panel.



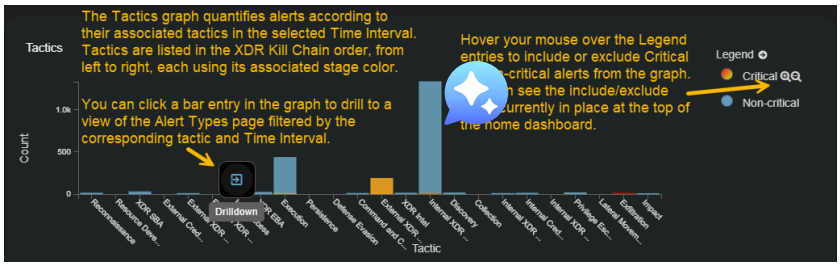
Assets are reported in the Top Assets panel with the highest-risk entries at the top. As shown in the figure below, each asset is listed with the following information and context-sensitive drilldowns:



- Risk score. The number in the circle indicates risk. The highest risk is 100 and the least is zero.
- IP address or hostname of the asset.
- Context menu access for drilldowns to the following additional Stellar Cyber for the asset:
    - Asset Detail View – Opens the **Assets | Asset Analytics | Asset Details** tab for the selected friendly name, hostname, or IP address as the filter.
    - *360* Panoramic View – Opens the **Dashboards | Panoramic** view with the selected friendly name, hostname, or IP address as the filter.
    - ***VT* VirusTotal Lookup** – Performs a lookup on virustotal.com for the selected friendly name, hostname, or IP address.
    - **Add as Including Filter** – Creates a filter to display only those events containing the value in the field.
    - **Add as Excluding Filter** – Filters out those events containing the value in the field.
    - **Copy to Clipboard** – Copies the field value to the clipboard so it can be pasted elsewhere.
    - **Copy as Query** – Copies a pre-built Lucene query that searches for related activity involving the IP address of the asset across multiple fields. Use this query in tools like Threat Hunting or Search to investigate communications where the IP appears as source, destination, or host.
- XDR Kill Chain summary. Alert counts are shown for each XDR Kill Chain stage, identified using their consistent stage icons and colors. Select any stage entry to drill to the Alert Types page, filtered for the corresponding asset and Kill Chain stage.
- A one-line summary for the most severe alert associated with the asset. Select the **More Info** icon to drill to the Event Display for the alert, including the supporting Interflow data.

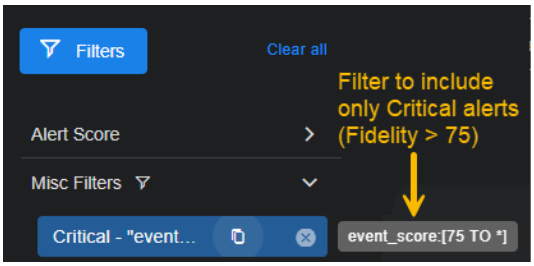
Tactics Graph

The Tactics graph at the bottom of the XDR Kill Chain dashboard quantifies alerts by their associated XDR Kill Chain tactic within the selected filters.



- Tactics are listed in XDR Kill Chain order, from left to right along the x-axis of the graph. Bar graph entries for each tactic are displayed in their corresponding XDR Kill Chain stage color.
- Drill to the Alert Types page by selecting any bar graph entry for a tactic and selecting the **Drilldown** pop-up that appears. In response, the Alert Types page appears, already filtered by the selected tactic and time interval.
- Hover your mouse over the **Legend** entries to include or exclude critical or non-critical alerts from the graph. Critical alerts are those with an Alert Score of 75 or greater.

  Once you've applied an include/exclude filter, you can see its current settings at the top of the display. As shown below, you can also clear the filter to return the display to its unfiltered state.

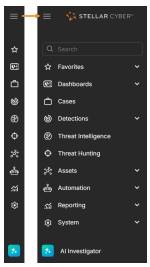


Common Menus and Controls

This section summarizes the common menus and controls that appear on Stellar Cyber pages:

Main Menu

The user interface has icons on the left side of the screen. Selectk the icon to expand the icons into text menus to navigate to any function in Stellar Cyber.



All the menus are described in the Overview of New User Interface.

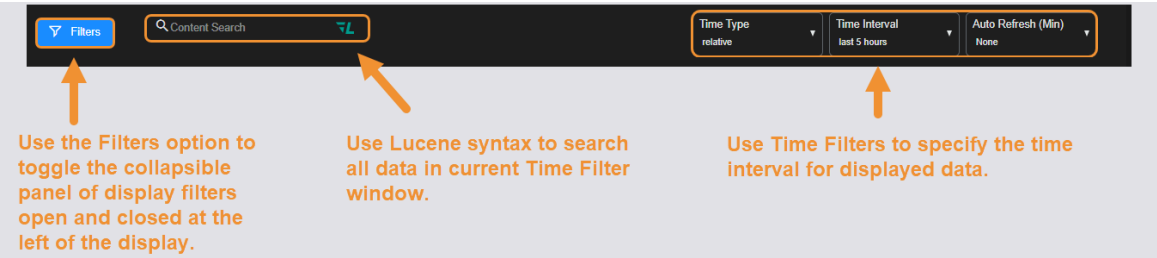
- Select the logo to get back to the current **Home** page.
- **Dashboards**: Access both predefined and custom dashboards, as well as create and manage new dashboards and charts.

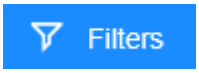
- **Cases**: Manage *cases*– sets of multiple correlated alerts – reported by Stellar Cyber.
- **Detections**: Display a of alerts observed by Stellar Cyber, organized by the XDR Kill Chain and analyzed with machine learning and view Detection Management.
- **Threat Intelligence**: Access both IoCs and threat intelligence feeds.
- **Threat Hunting**: Use selected views to perform threat hunting.
- **Assets**: View asset analytics and user behavior analytics.
- **Automation**: Define your own alert types through automation and initiate and manage actions such as user, firewall, or device actions taken in response to events.
- **Reporting**: Create and schedule reports.
- **System**: Access to administrative tools.

Filter Controls

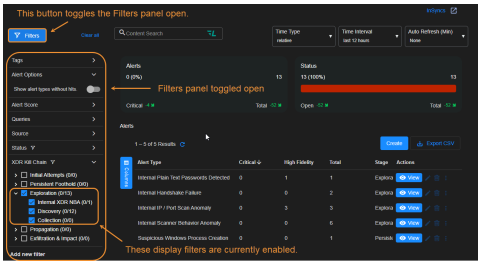
Stellar Cyber's display filters are available both in the **toolbar** and as a **collapsible panel** at the left of most displays:

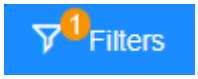
- **Toolbar filters** are at the top of pages that display query results, which is most pages in Stellar Cyber. For example:



- The **Filters panel** is available at the left of most displays by toggling it open with the 

button in the toolbar:



When you set a filter, the displayed data is immediately updated. In addition, if you set a filter from the Filters panel, the filter button updates to show the number of filters applied once the panel is toggled closed. For example – 

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The filter settings are persistent within a session. If you go to another page the search results remain the same. For example, if you are on the **Kill Chain** page and go to the **Threat Hunting** page, the same records are displayed.

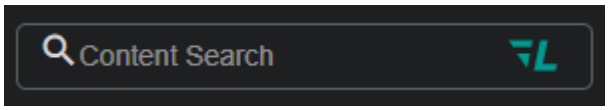
Each of the controls take effect immediately, except for a **Time Type** of **absolute**.

See the About Filters page for a complete description of these controls.

The filter settings are persistent for the current session. So they are maintained when you go to a new page.

You can configure a preset filter for all of your views on your User Profile.

Search Tool



The search tool performs a simple search on the set of records displayed. Although easy to use, it is capable of complex search operations. For more information see the About Search page.

Saved Query / Query Builder

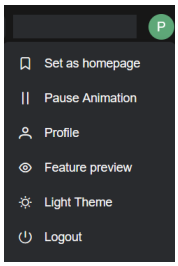
Use the Query Builder to construct both simple and complex queries that search the Stellar Cyber database.

You can also save and retrieve queries.

See About Queries for a complete description on how to use queries.

The current query setting is persistent for the current session and is maintained when you go to a new page.

Current User



The Current User dropdown shows an icon for the currently logged-in user in the upper, right-most corner of the user interface. It provides access to the following functions:

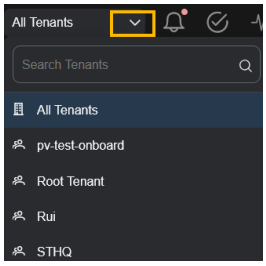
- **Set as homepage** – Lets you get back to the XDR Kill Chain Dashboard.
- **Pause Animation** – Lets you pause the animation of the XDR Kill Chain graphic.
- **Profile** – Lets you edit your user settings.
- **Feature preview** – Lets you switch between the legacy user interface and the new user interface
- **Light theme** – Lets you switch between the light theme and the dark theme
- **Logout** – Ends the current session and returns you to the **Login** page.

Selected Tenant

All records in the Stellar Cyber system are assigned to a tenant. In addition to the filter controls, search and query results can be narrowed to reflect only those records of a specific tenant. Alternatively, all tenants can be included.

Stellar Cyber users assigned to a tenant but who are not admin users cannot change the tenant setting.

Select the **Tenant** drop-down list at the top right of the user interface to change the selected tenant.

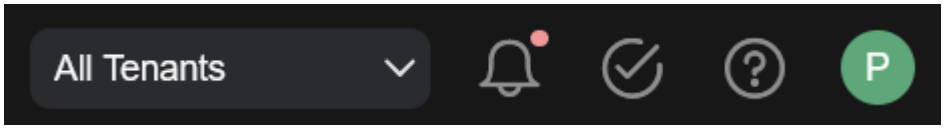


See the About Tenants page for more information on Stellar Cyber tenants.

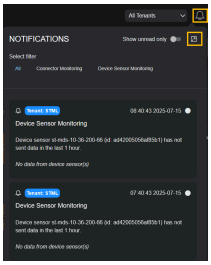
The **Select Tenants** setting is persistent within the current session and is maintained when you go to a new page.

Utility Icons

The icons at the upper right of the user interface provide access to general utilities.

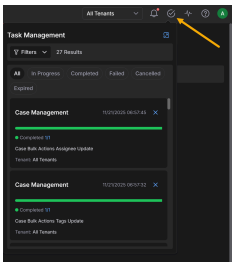


- Select the question mark icon to open the **Help** menu, which provides access to knowledge base topics, API documentation, the Resource Center, and other learning and support tools. For details, see .**Help Menu and Resource Center** .
- Select the alarm bell icon to open **Notifications** to show you the number of unread system notifications. Select the icon to launch the Notification Center. Users with appropriate access can specify rules that govern how system notifications are generated in the System Action Center.

- Select the tasks icon to open **Tasks** to keep track of the progress, success, or failure of ongoing Stellar Cyber activities (bulk actions to Cases, asset edits, cold data queries, tenant creations, data purges, tenant removals, and so on). You can only see tasks related to activities you yourself have initiated or those from other users who are within your user scope (for example, a **Super Admin** with **Root** scope can see tasks from all users).

  Here's how you display the Task List, complete with some successful bulk actions:



Depending on the type of task displayed and its current state, different options are available for managing tasks, including the ability to clear, and in some cases, cancel, ongoing tasks.

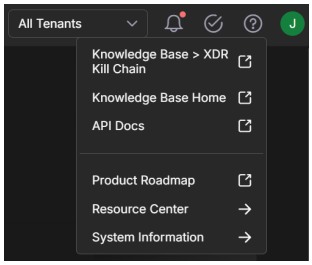
You can also view the Task List as its own page using the **System | Task Management** option.

Help Menu and Resource Center

The Help menu gives you direct access to documentation, training, and support resources. From the Help menu, you can open the Resource Center, which brings together walkthroughs, documentation, training, community discussions, support options, and Stellar Cyber news in a single location.

Help Menu

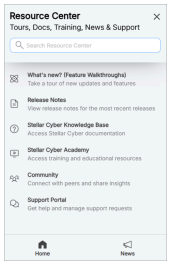
Select the question mark icon in the top-right menu bar to open the Help menu. From here, you can access context-sensitive Knowledge Base topics, the Knowledge Base home page, API references, Resource Center, and the Stellar Cyber software version that's currently running.



- **Knowledge Base >** *current page name* – Opens the specific knowledge base topic for the active page, providing context-sensitive help.
- **Knowledge Base Home** – Opens the home page of the Stellar Cyber Knowledge Base.
- **API Docs** – Opens a direct link to Swagger-based API documentation. Developers can use this interactive UI to understand all available endpoints, view request/response models, and execute live API calls for testing and validation.
- **Product Roadmap** – Discontinued.
- **Resource Center** – Opens the Resource Center (see below for details).
- **System Information** – Displays the version of the currently running Stellar Cyber software.

Resource Center

The Resource Center is a central hub for learning, documentation, and community access. From here, you can launch product walkthroughs for new and updated features by selecting **What's New? (Feature Walkthroughs)**, open Stellar Cyber release notes and documentation, access the Stellar Cyber Academy, join community discussions, and connect with the Support Portal. At the bottom of the Resource Center, you can stay current with the latest Stellar Cyber **News**.



It includes the following items:

- **What's New? (Feature Walkthroughs)** – Launches product walkthroughs that introduce new or updated features. The walkthroughs appear as interactive overlays on top of the user interface, highlighting selectable elements and providing clear, step-by-step guidance.

  After upgrading to a new Stellar Cyber software version, a banner appears at the top of the UI from which you can access walkthroughs. If you dismiss the banner, it does not reappear automatically. However, you can still access the walkthroughs later from the **What's New? (Feature Walkthroughs)** link in the Resource Center.

- **Release Notes** – Opens a list of the latest sets of Stellar Cyber release notes from which you can choose which ones to read.
- **Stellar Cyber Knowledge Base** – Opens the Stellar Cyber documentation home page (the same topic as the Knowledge Base Home link in the Help menu).
- **Stellar Cyber Academy** – Opens the Stellar Cyber Academy login page or home page, depending on your login state.
- **Community** – Opens the Stellar Cyber *Community* page in the Customer Success portal.
- **Support Portal** – Opens the Stellar Cyber Customer Success Sign In page or your account landing page, depending on your login state. From the landing page you can view or create support tickets and access additional Customer Success resources such as announcements, documentation, community discussions, and training links.

At the top of the Resource Center is a search tool that lets you search the content in the Resource Center.

At the bottom of the Resource Center are two additional options: **Home** and **News**. Selecting **Home** returns to the Resource Center with all the links described above. Selecting **News** opens a list of recent Stellar Cyber news articles such as blog posts, podcasts, webcasts, and so on.

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